

Challenge Write-Up Template

Instructions: Copy this template for every challenge you submit. Fill in every section — a write-up that only shows the final flag without explanation will not receive full credit. Delete these italicized instruction lines before submitting.

Challenge Information

Student Name	<i>Facon, Janna Mae L.</i>
Section / Class	<i>BSIT- 3G</i>
Challenge Name	<i>MY GIT</i>
Category	<i>General Skills</i>
Points / Difficulty	<i>Easy</i>
Date Solved	<i>8/12/2026</i>
Flag Format Given	<i>PicoCTF{...}</i>

1. Challenge Description

Restate the challenge in your own words: what were you given, and what were you asked to find or do? Do not simply copy-paste the original prompt.

The My Git challenge involved working with a Git repository hosted on a remote server. The challenge explained that the server had its own Git rules, and the goal was to make a commit that satisfied those rules in order to obtain the flag. I needed to clone the repository, inspect the provided instructions, create the required flag.txt file, configure the Git author information correctly, commit the file, and push the commit to the remote repository.

2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

What did you check first? What did file, strings, a webpage view-source, or another first look tell you? What category did you decide this was, and why?

*The first step I did was read the challenge description to understand what the challenge was asking me to do. I identified that this was a **General Skills** challenge focused on Git and repository operations. After launching the instance, I connected to the remote Git server and cloned the challenge repository. I then entered the challenge directory and used `ls -la` to inspect the repository files. I found a `.git` directory and a `README.md` file. I opened the `README` using `cat README.md`, which explained that the flag would be updated only if `flag.txt` was pushed by the required Git author. From this, I understood that the important part of the challenge was not only creating and pushing the file, but also making sure the Git commit author matched the required identity.*

3. Tools and Commands Used

List every tool/command you used, in the order you used them, and what each one told you.

Tool / Command	What it was used for	Result / Output
<code>git clone</code>	Cloned the remote Git repository so I could work on the challenge locally.	The repository was successfully cloned into the <code>my_git</code> directory.
<code>ls</code>	<i>Checked the contents of the cloned repository.</i>	<i>The challenge directory was displayed.</i>
<code>cd challenge/</code>	<i>Entered the challenge repository directory.</i>	<i>The terminal was now working inside the challenge repository.</i>
<code>ls -la</code>	<i>Inspected all files, including hidden Git files.</i>	<i>The <code>.git</code> directory and <code>README.md</code> were present.</i>
<code>cat README.md</code>	Read the challenge instructions.	<i>The README explained that <code>flag.txt</code> needed to be pushed by the required Git author.</i>
<code>echo 'janna' > flag.txt</code>	<i>Created the required <code>flag.txt</code> file.</i>	<i>A file named <code>flag.txt</code> containing <code>janna</code> was created.</i>
<code>git config user.email "root@picoctf"</code>	<i>Checked the contents of the new file.</i>	<i>The output was <code>janna</code>.</i>
<code>git config user.name "root"</code>	<i>Set the Git username to the required author identity.</i>	<i>The Git username was configured as <code>root</code>.</i>
<code>git add flag.txt</code>	<i>Staged the new <code>flag</code> file for the commit.</i>	<i><code>flag.txt</code> was added to the Git staging area.</i>
<code>git commit -a -m "added flag.txt file"</code>	<i>Created a commit containing the file.</i>	<i>The commit was created successfully.</i>
<code>git push</code>	Sent the commit to the remote Git server.	<i>The server accepted the commit because the author matched the required identity and returned the flag.</i>

4. Solution Walkthrough

Explain your reasoning step by step — not just what you typed, but why you tried it and what you concluded from the result. Include screenshots, code snippets, or command output where useful. A reader who has not seen the challenge should be able to follow your logic and arrive at the same answer.

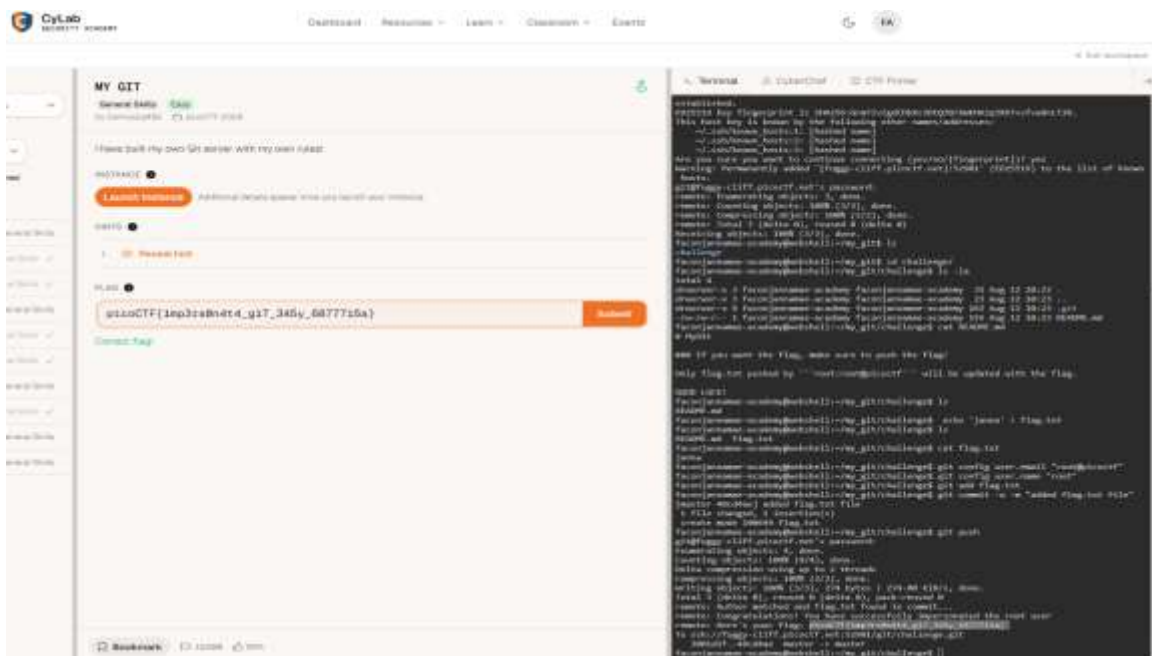
Step 1

The first step I did was read the challenge description. I saw that the challenge was called **My Git** and that it involved a custom Git server with its own rules. I launched the instance and connected to the remote Git repository. After cloning the repository, I used `ls` and entered the challenge directory with `cd challenge/`. I then used `ls -la` to inspect the repository and found the `.git` directory and `README.md`. I read the instructions using `cat README.md` to understand what the server required before pushing anything.



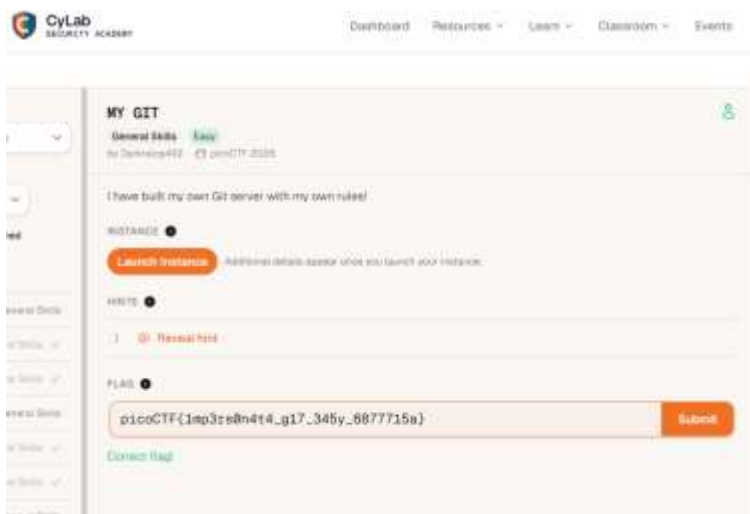
Step 2

After reading the README, I learned that I needed to create a `flag.txt` file and push it using the required Git author information. I created the file with: `echo 'janna' > flag.txt` I then checked that the file contained the expected text by using: `cat flag.txt` The terminal displayed `janna`, confirming that the file was created correctly. I then configured the Git author to match the required identity using: `git config user.email "root@picoctf"` `git config user.name "root"` After configuring the author, I staged and committed the file: `git add flag.txt` `git commit -a -m "added flag.txt file"` The terminal showed that the commit was successfully created.



Step 3

The final step was to push the commit to the remote server using: `git push` The server accepted the push and checked the author information. The terminal output confirmed that the **author matched** and that I had successfully impersonated the required root user. The server then returned the flag: `picoCTF{1mp3rs0n4t4_g17_345y_6877715a}` I copied the flag and entered it into the **FLAG** field on the My Git challenge page.



5. Flag

`picoCTF{1mp3rs0n4t4_g17_345y_6877715a}`

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

In 2-4 sentences, name the underlying security concept or vulnerability class this challenge taught (e.g. "weak RSA exponent," "reflected XSS," "stack buffer overflow"). This is the part of the write-up most worth remembering after the flag is submitted.

*This challenge taught me about **Git commit authorship and identity configuration**. I learned that Git records the username and email associated with a commit, and that a server can use this information to determine whether a commit was made by an authorized user. By configuring the Git identity to match the required root author and successfully pushing the commit, I was able to satisfy the server's rule and obtain the flag.*

7. References

List any external resource you consulted beyond course materials (a tool's documentation, a technique explainer, a similar public write-up). It is normal and expected to use references — just cite them.

<https://youtu.be/1MO5aHTnN1k?si=anPSVDrGjmAKrmsW>
